Whistleblowing Policy

1 Purpose

This policy gives anyone concerned about wrongdoing connected to Girl Pride Africa Kenya (GPAK) a safe way to raise it, and sets out what GPAK does with a report. It works alongside POL-01 (Safeguarding and PSEA Policy), POL-04 (Complaints and Feedback Policy) and POL-05 (Anti-Fraud, Bribery and Corruption Policy).

> A safeguarding concern about a participant's safety is reported immediately, not held for this policy: report it straight away to the Safeguarding Focal Point under POL-01. This policy is the right route where the concern is about wrongdoing by GPAK, its staff, its Advisory Committee, a mentor mother or a community volunteer, including where the Safeguarding Focal Point or the Director is the person of concern.

2 Who can report

Any GPAK staff member, Advisory Committee member, mentor mother, community volunteer, intern, consultant, contractor, partner, participant or member of the public may report under this policy.

3 What to report

- Fraud, bribery or corruption (POL-05).
- A breach of a GPAK policy or Kenyan law.
- A danger to a participant's, a staff member's or the public's health or safety.
- Misuse of GPAK funds, property or data.
- A serious conflict of interest that is not being managed (POL-07).
- An attempt to cover up any of the above.

4 Channels

A report can be made:

- In writing: a letter, an email to info@gpakgirls.org marked confidential, or a note handed to the Director or the Chair of the Advisory Committee.
- By phone: +254 725 737 867, or directly to the Chair of the Advisory Committee where the Director is involved.
- Anonymously: a note left at the GPAK office or a feedback card (POL-04).

A report goes to the Director. Where the report concerns the Director, or the reporter does not want to approach the Director, it goes to the Chair of the Advisory Committee instead.

5 Protection from retaliation

GPAK does not penalise, demote, dismiss, exclude from a programme or community role, or otherwise retaliate against anyone who makes a report in good faith under this policy, whether or not the concern is later substantiated. Someone who believes they have faced retaliation for a genuine report can raise this directly with the Chair of the Advisory Committee.

6 Confidentiality

The reporter's identity is shared only with those who need it to assess or investigate the report, and only with the reporter's agreement where possible. An anonymous report is accepted and assessed on the same basis,

though limited detail may limit how far it can be investigated. Records are kept securely and access is limited to those handling the report.

7 False and malicious reports

A report made in good faith is protected even if it turns out to be mistaken. A report known to be false, or made maliciously to harm another person, is a disciplinary matter under POL-10 (Human Resources and Volunteer Policy), or, for a community role, grounds to end the role's agreement.

8 Handling and timeline

1. The report is acknowledged to the reporter, where contact details are available, within 5 working days.
2. The Director, or the Chair of the Advisory Committee where the Director is involved, decides how to assess or investigate the report, and does not involve anyone implicated in it.
3. An initial assessment is completed within 10 working days of the report, deciding whether to investigate further, to refer it (for example to the Safeguarding Focal Point under POL-01, or as a suspected fraud under POL-05), or to close it with reasons recorded.
4. Where possible, the reporter receives feedback on the outcome, balanced against the confidentiality this policy owes to other people involved.
5. Where the investigation substantiates the concern, GPAK acts under the relevant policy (POL-01, POL-05, POL-07, POL-09 or POL-10) and reports the outcome to the Advisory Committee.

9 Records

GPAK keeps a confidential log of whistleblowing reports (date, channel, the nature of the concern, who handled it, and the outcome, without necessarily naming the reporter). The Advisory Committee reviews this log in aggregate, alongside the safeguarding and complaints reports required under GOV-01. Records are kept for at least 7 years and stored securely, with access limited to those who need it.

10 External routes

A person may also report directly to an outside body:

- The Ethics and Anti-Corruption Commission (EACC), for suspected corruption.
- The police, for a criminal matter.
- The Public Benefit Organizations Regulatory Authority (PBORA), for a regulatory concern about GPAK.
- A funder, for a concern connected to its funding.

Using an external route does not affect a person's protection under this policy.

Approval and review

Item	Detail
Policy owner	Director
Approved by	Advisory Committee
Applies to	All GPAK staff, Advisory Committee members, volunteers, mentor mothers, community volunteers, interns, consultants, contractors and partners working on GPAK activities
Review	Every two years, or earlier if the law, a funder requirement or an incident review shows that a change is needed.

Public copy. Internal forms, annexes and signature pages are kept on file by GPAK and are available on request.